Chapter 14. Nested and Split-Plot Designs

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1 Introduction

- Multifactor experiments with important industrial applications.
- They frequently involve one or more random factors, so the methodology of Ch. 13 (expected mean squares, variance components) is essential.
- Many variations exist; we consider the basic situations.

2 The Two-Stage Nested Design

2.1 Crossed vs nested

In a **nested** (hierarchical) design the levels of factor B are similar but *not identical* at different levels of factor A: batch 1 of supplier 1 has nothing to do with batch 1 of supplier 2.

Derivation: layout

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
Supplier 1	○	○	○	○								
Supplier 2					○	○	○	○				
Supplier 3									○	○	○	○

Each supplier has its own 4 batches: 12 distinct batches, labelled 1–4 within each supplier.

Example: Purity of raw material

A company buys raw material from 3 suppliers; the material comes in batches. Is purity uniform? Select 4 batches at random from each supplier and make 3 purity determinations on each batch (coded data):

Supplier	1				2				3			
Batch	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
	1	−2	−2	1	1	0	−1	0	2	−2	1	3
	−1	−3	0	4	−2	4	0	3	4	0	−1	2
	0	−4	1	0	−3	2	−2	2	0	2	2	1
$y_{ij\cdot}$	0	−9	−1	5	−4	6	−3	5	6	0	2	6
$y_{i\cdot\cdot}$		−5				4				14		

2.2 Model and decomposition

Definition

$$y_{ijk} = \mu + \tau_i + \beta_{j(i)} + \varepsilon_{(ij)k}, \qquad i = 1, \ldots, a;\ j = 1, \ldots, b;\ k = 1, \ldots, n,$$

$j(i)$: the jth level of B nested under the ith level of A; each replicate is nested within the (i, j) combination, hence $\varepsilon_{(ij)k}$. There is **no** $A \times B$ interaction (every level of B appears with only one level of A).

Theorem

$$\sum_i\sum_j\sum_k (y_{ijk}-\bar y_{\cdots})^2 = bn\sum_i(\bar y_{i\cdot\cdot}-\bar y_{\cdots})^2 + n\sum_i\sum_j(\bar y_{ij\cdot}-\bar y_{i\cdot\cdot})^2 + \sum_i\sum_j\sum_k(y_{ijk}-\bar y_{ij\cdot})^2,$$

$$SS_T = SS_A + SS_{B(A)} + SS_E, \quad abn-1 = (a-1)+a(b-1)+ab(n-1).$$

Proof. $y_{ijk}-\bar y_{\cdots} = (\bar y_{i\cdot\cdot}-\bar y_{\cdots}) + (\bar y_{ij\cdot}-\bar y_{i\cdot\cdot}) + (y_{ijk}-\bar y_{ij\cdot})$. Cross products:

$$\sum_i\sum_j\sum_k (\bar y_{i\cdot\cdot}-\bar y_{\cdots})(\bar y_{ij\cdot}-\bar y_{i\cdot\cdot}) = n\sum_i(\bar y_{i\cdot\cdot}-\bar y_{\cdots})\underbrace{\sum_j(\bar y_{ij\cdot}-\bar y_{i\cdot\cdot})}_{=0} = 0,$$

and any product with $(y_{ijk}-\bar y_{ij\cdot})$ vanishes after summing over k. DF of $B(A)$: within each of the a levels of A, $b-1$ df, total $a(b-1)$. Note $SS_{B(A)} = SS_B + SS_{AB}$ of a (wrongly) crossed analysis: $a(b-1) = (b-1)+(a-1)(b-1)$. ■

Source	SS	DF	MS
A	SS_A	$a-1$	MS_A
B within A	$SS_{B(A)}$	$a(b-1)$	$MS_{B(A)}$
Error	SS_E	$ab(n-1)$	MS_E
Total	SS_T	$abn-1$	

2.3 Expected mean squares: three cases

Case 1: A fixed, B fixed ($\sum_i \tau_i = 0$, $\sum_j \beta_{j(i)} = 0$ for each i).

Term	F a i	F b j	R n k	EMS
τ_i	0	b	n	$\sigma^2 + bn\sum\tau_i^2/(a-1)$
$\beta_{j(i)}$	1	0	n	$\sigma^2 + n\sum\sum\beta_{j(i)}^2/[a(b-1)]$
$\varepsilon_{(ij)k}$	1	1	1	σ^2

$H_0: \tau_i = 0$: $F_0 = MS_A/MS_E$; $H_0: \beta_{j(i)} = 0$: $F_0 = MS_{B(A)}/MS_E$. Estimates $\hat\tau_i = \bar y_{i\cdot\cdot} - \bar y_{\cdots}$, $\hat\beta_{j(i)} = \bar y_{ij\cdot} - \bar y_{i\cdot\cdot}$, $\hat\sigma^2 = MS_E$.

Case 2: A random, B random ($\tau_i \sim N(0,\sigma_\tau^2)$, $\beta_{j(i)} \sim N(0,\sigma_\beta^2)$).

Term	R i	R j	R k	EMS
τ_i	1	b	n	$\sigma^2 + n\sigma_\beta^2 + bn\sigma_\tau^2$
$\beta_{j(i)}$	1	1	n	$\sigma^2 + n\sigma_\beta^2$
$\varepsilon_{(ij)k}$	1	1	1	σ^2

$H_0: \sigma_\tau^2 = 0$: $F_0 = MS_A/MS_{B(A)}$; $H_0: \sigma_\beta^2 = 0$: $F_0 = MS_{B(A)}/MS_E$. $\hat\sigma^2 = MS_E$, $\hat\sigma_\beta^2 = \frac{MS_{B(A)}-MS_E}{n}$, $\hat\sigma_\tau^2 = \frac{MS_A - MS_{B(A)}}{bn}$.

Case 3: A fixed, B random (mixed).

Term	F i	R j	R k	EMS
τ_i	0	b	n	$\sigma^2 + n\sigma^2_\beta + bn\sum \tau_i^2/(a-1)$
$\beta_{j(i)}$	1	1	n	$\sigma^2 + n\sigma^2_\beta$
$\varepsilon_{(ij)k}$	1	1	1	σ^2

$H_0 : \tau_i = 0$: $F_0 = MS_A/MS_{B(A)}$; $H_0 : \sigma^2_\beta = 0$: $F_0 = MS_{B(A)}/MS_E$. $\hat\tau_i = \bar y_{i\cdot\cdot} - \bar y_{\cdots}$, $\hat\sigma^2 = MS_E$, $\hat\sigma^2_\beta = \frac{MS_{B(A)} - MS_E}{n}$.

Direct derivation of $\mathrm{E}(MS_A)$ in Case 2. $\bar y_{i\cdot\cdot} = \mu + \tau_i + \bar\beta_{\cdot(i)} + \bar\varepsilon_{i\cdot\cdot}$ with $\bar\beta_{\cdot(i)} = \frac{1}{b}\sum_j \beta_{j(i)}$; the $\bar\beta_{\cdot(i)}$ are iid with variance σ^2_β/b (each supplier has its own batches). So

$$\mathrm{E}(MS_A) = bn\Big[\mathrm{Var}(\tau_i) + \mathrm{Var}(\bar\beta_{\cdot(i)}) + \mathrm{Var}(\bar\varepsilon_{i\cdot\cdot})\Big] = bn\Big[\sigma^2_\tau + \frac{\sigma^2_\beta}{b} + \frac{\sigma^2}{bn}\Big] = bn\sigma^2_\tau + n\sigma^2_\beta + \sigma^2.$$

Similarly $\bar y_{ij\cdot} - \bar y_{i\cdot\cdot} = (\beta_{j(i)} - \bar\beta_{\cdot(i)}) + (\bar\varepsilon_{ij\cdot} - \bar\varepsilon_{i\cdot\cdot})$ gives $\mathrm{E}(MS_{B(A)}) = n(\sigma^2_\beta + \sigma^2/n) = n\sigma^2_\beta + \sigma^2$. ■

Example: Purity data, line by line

$\sum y^2 = 153$, $y_{\cdots} = 13$, $y^2_{\cdots}/36 = 4.694$.

$$\begin{aligned}
SS_T &= 153 - 4.694 = 148.31,\\
SS_A &= \frac{(-5)^2 + 4^2 + 14^2}{12} - 4.694 = \frac{237}{12} - 4.694 = 19.750 - 4.694 = 15.06,\\
SS_{B(A)} &= \frac{\sum_i \sum_j y^2_{ij\cdot}}{3} - \frac{\sum_i y^2_{i\cdot\cdot}}{12}\\
&= \frac{0^2 + (-9)^2 + (-1)^2 + 5^2 + (-4)^2 + 6^2 + (-3)^2 + 5^2 + 6^2 + 0^2 + 2^2 + 6^2}{3} - \frac{237}{12}\\
&= \frac{269}{3} - 19.75 = 69.92,\\
SS_E &= 148.31 - 15.06 - 69.92 = 63.33.
\end{aligned}$$

Source	SS	DF	MS	F_0 A,B fixed	F_0 A fixed, B random	F_0 A,B random
Suppliers	15.06	2	7.53	$\frac{7.53}{2.64} = 2.85$	$\frac{7.53}{7.77} = 0.97$	0.97
Batches(Suppliers)	69.92	9	7.77	$\frac{7.77}{2.64} = 2.94$	2.94	2.94
Error	63.33	24	2.64			
Total	148.31	35				

With suppliers fixed and batches random (the natural model): $F_0 = 0.97 < F_{0.05,2,9} = 4.26$ — no supplier difference; $F_0 = 2.94 > F_{0.05,9,24} = 2.30$ — significant batch-to-batch variability within suppliers. $\hat\sigma^2_\beta = \frac{7.77 - 2.64}{3} = 1.71$, $\hat\sigma^2 = 2.64$: the batch variance is a sizeable part of total variability — the suppliers should reduce batch-to-batch variation.
Warning: using a factorial (crossed) analysis here would wrongly split $SS_{B(A)}$ into SS_B and SS_{AB}.

Example: Plants and leaves (Final 2025)

Three plants (random), two leaves per plant (random, nested), n determinations per leaf: $y_{ijk} = \mu + \tau_i + \beta_{j(i)} + \varepsilon_{(ij)k}$, $\tau_i \sim N(0, \sigma^2_\tau)$, $\beta_{j(i)} \sim N(0, \sigma^2_\beta)$, $\varepsilon \sim N(0, \sigma^2)$; leaves are *nested* in plants (leaf 1 of plant 1 $\neq$ leaf 1 of plant 2), both random.

Source	DF	MS	EMS	F_0
Plants	2	MS_A	$\sigma^2 + n\sigma^2_\beta + 2n\sigma^2_\tau$	$MS_A/MS_{B(A)}$
Leaves(Plants)	$3(2-1)=3$	$MS_{B(A)}$	$\sigma^2 + n\sigma^2_\beta$	$MS_{B(A)}/MS_E$
Error	$6(n-1)$	MS_E	σ^2	
Total	$6n-1$			

3 The Three-Stage Nested Design

Derivation

$$y_{ijkl} = \mu + \tau_i + \beta_{j(i)} + \gamma_{k(ij)} + \varepsilon_{(ijk)l},$$

$$y_{ijkl} - \bar{y}_{....} = (\bar{y}_{i...} - \bar{y}_{....}) + (\bar{y}_{ij..} - \bar{y}_{i...}) + (\bar{y}_{ijk.} - \bar{y}_{ij..}) + (y_{ijkl} - \bar{y}_{ijk.}),$$

$SS_T = SS_A + SS_{B(A)} + SS_{C(B)} + SS_E$ with df $(a-1)$, $a(b-1)$, $ab(c-1)$, $abc(n-1)$.

EMS with A, B fixed and C random:

	F	F	R	R	
	a	b	c	n	
Term	i	j	k	l	EMS
τ_i	0	b	c	n	$\sigma^2 + n\sigma^2_\gamma + bcn\sum \tau_i^2/(a-1)$
$\beta_{j(i)}$	1	0	c	n	$\sigma^2 + n\sigma^2_\gamma + cn\sum\sum \beta^2_{j(i)}/[a(b-1)]$
$\gamma_{k(ij)}$	1	1	1	n	$\sigma^2 + n\sigma^2_\gamma$
$\varepsilon_{(ijk)l}$	1	1	1	1	σ^2

Tests: $H_0: \tau_i = 0$: $F_0 = MS_A/MS_{C(B)}$; $H_0: \beta_{j(i)} = 0$: $F_0 = MS_{B(A)}/MS_{C(B)}$; $H_0: \sigma^2_\gamma = 0$: $F_0 = MS_{C(B)}/MS_E$.

4 Designs with Both Nested and Factorial Factors

Example: Hand insertion of electronic components

Factors: 3 assembly fixtures (A, fixed), 2 workplace layouts (B, fixed), 4 operators per layout (C, random). Because the layouts are in different areas of the plant, different operators are used for each layout: **operators are nested within layouts**, while fixtures are crossed with layouts and with operators. $n = 2$ replicates.

$$y_{ijkl} = \mu + \tau_i + \beta_j + \gamma_{k(j)} + (\tau\beta)_{ij} + (\tau\gamma)_{ik(j)} + \varepsilon_{(ijk)l},$$

τ_i: fixture, β_j: layout, $\gamma_{k(j)}$: operator within layout. ($\sum \tau_i = \sum \beta_j = 0$, $\sum_i (\tau\beta)_{ij} = \sum_j (\tau\beta)_{ij} = 0$, $\gamma_{k(j)} \sim N(0, \sigma^2_\gamma)$, $(\tau\gamma)_{ik(j)} \sim N(0, \frac{a-1}{a}\sigma^2_{\tau\gamma})$ with $\sum_i (\tau\gamma)_{ik(j)} = 0$, $\varepsilon \sim N(0, \sigma^2)$.)

Term	F 3 i	F 2 j	R 4 k	R 2 l	DF	EMS
τ_i	0	2	4	2	$a-1=2$	$\sigma^2+2\sigma^2_{\tau\gamma}+16\sum\tau_i^2/2$
β_j	3	0	4	2	$b-1=1$	$\sigma^2+6\sigma^2_{\gamma}+24\sum\beta_j^2$
$\gamma_{k(j)}$	3	1	1	2	$b(c-1)=6$	$\sigma^2+6\sigma^2_{\gamma}$
$(\tau\beta)_{ij}$	0	0	4	2	$(a-1)(b-1)=2$	$\sigma^2+2\sigma^2_{\tau\gamma}+8\sum\sum(\tau\beta)_{ij}^2/2$
$(\tau\gamma)_{ik(j)}$	0	1	1	2	$(a-1)b(c-1)=12$	$\sigma^2+2\sigma^2_{\tau\gamma}$
$\varepsilon_{(ijk)l}$	1	1	1	1	$abc(n-1)=24$	σ^2

General form: $\mathrm{E}(MS_A)=\sigma^2+n\sigma^2_{\tau\gamma}+bcn\frac{\sum\tau_i^2}{a-1}$, $\mathrm{E}(MS_B)=\sigma^2+an\sigma^2_{\gamma}+acn\frac{\sum\beta_j^2}{b-1}$, $\mathrm{E}(MS_{C(B)})=\sigma^2+an\sigma^2_{\gamma}$, $\mathrm{E}(MS_{AB})=\sigma^2+n\sigma^2_{\tau\gamma}+cn\frac{\sum\sum(\tau\beta)^2}{(a-1)(b-1)}$, $\mathrm{E}(MS_{AC(B)})=\sigma^2+n\sigma^2_{\tau\gamma}$.

Source	SS	DF	MS	F_0
Fixtures	82.80	2	41.40	$41.40/5.49=7.54$
Layouts	4.08	1	4.08	$4.08/11.99=0.34$
Operators(layout)	71.91	6	11.99	$11.99/2.33=5.14$
Fixture×Layout	19.04	2	9.52	$9.52/5.49=1.73$
Fixture×Operator(layout)	65.84	12	5.49	$5.49/2.33=2.35$
Error	56.00	24	2.33	
Total	299.67	47		

Fixtures significant ($F_{0.05,2,12}=3.89$), layouts not ($F_{0.05,1,6}=5.99$), operators within layouts significant ($F_{0.05,6,24}=2.51$), fixture×operator significant ($F_{0.05,12,24}=2.18$). Variance components: $\hat\sigma^2_{\gamma}=\frac{11.99-2.33}{6}=1.61$, $\hat\sigma^2_{\tau\gamma}=\frac{5.49-2.33}{2}=1.58$, $\hat\sigma^2=2.33$.
Tests summary: $H_0:\tau_i=0$: $\frac{MS_A}{MS_{AC(B)}}$, $\hat\tau_i=\bar y_{i\cdots}-\bar y$; $H_0:\beta_j=0$: $\frac{MS_B}{MS_{C(B)}}$; $H_0:\sigma^2_{\gamma}=0$: $\frac{MS_{C(B)}}{MS_E}$, $\hat\sigma^2_{\gamma}=\frac{MS_{C(B)}-MS_E}{an}$; $H_0:\sigma^2_{\tau\gamma}=0$: $\frac{MS_{AC(B)}}{MS_E}$, $\hat\sigma^2_{\tau\gamma}=\frac{MS_{AC(B)}-MS_E}{n}$; $H_0:(\tau\beta)_{ij}=0$: $\frac{MS_{AB}}{MS_{AC(B)}}$, $\widehat{(\tau\beta)}_{ij}=\bar y_{ij\cdot\cdot}-\bar y_{i\cdots}-\bar y_{\cdot j\cdot\cdot}+\bar y$.

5 The Split-Plot Design

5.1 Motivation

- *Electrical components life test*: baking time (5, 10, 15 min) × oven temperature (580, 600, 620, 640). A true CRD would heat the oven to a random temperature, bake one component for a random time, and repeat — impractical and expensive. In practice the oven is heated to one temperature and all 9 components are inserted (3 per baking time). This is a **restriction on randomization**.
- The **split-plot** design is a multifactor experiment in which it is not possible to completely randomize the order of the runs.
- *Paper manufacturing*: 3 pulp preparation methods × 4 cooking temperatures, 3 replicates. A CRD would need $3\times12=36$ batches of pulp. Pulp preparation is a **hard-to-change** factor. Split-plot: in each replicate, prepare a batch with one pulp method, divide it into 4 samples, cook each at a different temperature; repeat for each method. Only $3\times3=9$ batches are needed.

- Each replicate (block) is divided into three **whole plots**; pulp method is the **whole-plot treatment**.
- Each whole plot is divided into four **subplots** (split plots); temperature is the **subplot treatment**.
- Generally the hard-to-change factor is assigned to the whole plots.

Example: Paper tensile strength data

	Rep 1			Rep 2			Rep 3		
Temp	P1	P2	P3	P1	P2	P3	P1	P2	P3
200	30	34	29	28	31	31	31	35	32
225	35	41	26	32	36	30	37	40	34
250	37	38	33	40	42	32	41	39	39
275	36	42	36	41	40	40	40	44	45

5.2 Split-plot model I (full model)

Derivation

$$y_{ijk} = \mu + \underbrace{\tau_i + \beta_j + (\tau\beta)_{ij}}_{\text{whole-plot part}} + \underbrace{\gamma_k + (\tau\gamma)_{ik} + (\beta\gamma)_{jk} + (\tau\beta\gamma)_{ijk}}_{\text{subplot part}} + \varepsilon_{(ijk)1},$$

$i = 1, \ldots, r$ (blocks/replicates, random), $j = 1, \ldots, a$ (factor A, whole plot, fixed), $k = 1, \ldots, b$ (factor B, subplot, fixed), one observation per cell.

- Whole-plot part: τ_i block effect ($\sim N(0, \sigma^2_\tau)$); β_j effect of A ($\sum \beta_j = 0$); $(\tau\beta)_{ij}$ whole-plot error ($\sim N(0, \sigma^2_{\tau\beta})$).
- Subplot part: γ_k effect of B ($\sum \gamma_k = 0$); $(\tau\gamma)_{ik}$ block×B ($\sim N(0, \sigma^2_{\tau\gamma})$); $(\beta\gamma)_{jk}$ A×B ($\sum_j = \sum_k = 0$); $(\tau\beta\gamma)_{ijk}$ subplot error ($\sim N(0, \sigma^2_{\tau\beta\gamma})$).

Decomposition:

$$\begin{aligned} y_{ijk} - \bar{y}_{\cdots} = {} & (\bar{y}_{i\cdot\cdot} - \bar{y}_{\cdots}) + (\bar{y}_{\cdot j\cdot} - \bar{y}_{\cdots}) + (\bar{y}_{\cdot\cdot k} - \bar{y}_{\cdots}) + (\bar{y}_{ij\cdot} - \bar{y}_{i\cdot\cdot} - \bar{y}_{\cdot j\cdot} + \bar{y}_{\cdots}) \\ & + (\bar{y}_{i\cdot k} - \bar{y}_{i\cdot\cdot} - \bar{y}_{\cdot\cdot k} + \bar{y}_{\cdots}) + (\bar{y}_{\cdot jk} - \bar{y}_{\cdot j\cdot} - \bar{y}_{\cdot\cdot k} + \bar{y}_{\cdots}) \\ & + (y_{ijk} - \bar{y}_{ij\cdot} - \bar{y}_{i\cdot k} - \bar{y}_{\cdot jk} + \bar{y}_{i\cdot\cdot} + \bar{y}_{\cdot j\cdot} + \bar{y}_{\cdot\cdot k} - \bar{y}_{\cdots}), \end{aligned}$$

$$SS_T = SS_{\text{Block}} + SS_A + SS_B + SS_{E(w)} + SS_{\text{Block}\times B} + SS_{AB} + SS_{E(s)},$$

$$rab - 1 = (r-1) + (a-1) + (b-1) + (r-1)(a-1) + (r-1)(b-1) + (a-1)(b-1) + (r-1)(a-1)(b-1).$$

Term	R i	F j	F k	R l	EMS
τ_i	1	a	b	1	$\sigma^2 + ab\sigma^2_\tau$
β_j	r	0	b	1	$\sigma^2 + b\sigma^2_{\tau\beta} + rb\sum\beta_j^2/(a-1)$
$(\tau\beta)_{ij}$	1	0	b	1	$\sigma^2 + b\sigma^2_{\tau\beta}$
γ_k	r	a	0	1	$\sigma^2 + a\sigma^2_{\tau\gamma} + ra\sum\gamma_k^2/(b-1)$
$(\tau\gamma)_{ik}$	1	a	0	1	$\sigma^2 + a\sigma^2_{\tau\gamma}$
$(\beta\gamma)_{jk}$	r	0	0	1	$\sigma^2 + \sigma^2_{\tau\beta\gamma} + r\sum\sum(\beta\gamma)^2_{jk}/[(a-1)(b-1)]$
$(\tau\beta\gamma)_{ijk}$	1	0	0	1	$\sigma^2 + \sigma^2_{\tau\beta\gamma}$
$\varepsilon_{(ijk)l}$	1	1	1	1	σ^2 (not estimable)

Since there is one observation per cell, ε has 0 df and is inseparable from $(\tau\beta\gamma)_{ijk}$ (i.e. σ^2 is confounded with $\sigma^2_{\tau\beta\gamma}$). Tests:

- A: $MS_A/MS_{(\tau\beta)}$ (whole-plot error);
- B: $MS_B/MS_{(\tau\gamma)}$;
- AB: $MS_{AB}/MS_{(\tau\beta\gamma)}$;
- blocks: no exact test.

5.3 Split-plot model II (alternate model)

$$y_{ijk} = \mu + \tau_i + \beta_j + (\tau\beta)_{ij} + \gamma_k + (\beta\gamma)_{jk} + \varepsilon_{ijk},$$

assuming block×B and block×A×B interactions are negligible, so they are pooled into the subplot error ε_{ijk} ($\tau_i \sim N(0,\sigma^2_\tau)$, $\sum\beta_j = 0$, $(\tau\beta)_{ij} \sim N(0,\sigma^2_{\tau\beta})$, $\sum\gamma_k = 0$, $\sum_j(\beta\gamma)_{jk} = \sum_k(\beta\gamma)_{jk} = 0$, $\varepsilon_{ijk} \sim N(0,\sigma^2)$).

$$\begin{aligned} y_{ijk} - \bar{y}_{\cdots} = {} & (\bar{y}_{i\cdot\cdot} - \bar{y}_{\cdots}) + (\bar{y}_{\cdot j\cdot} - \bar{y}_{\cdots}) + (\bar{y}_{ij\cdot} - \bar{y}_{i\cdot\cdot} - \bar{y}_{\cdot j\cdot} + \bar{y}_{\cdots}) \\ & + (\bar{y}_{\cdot\cdot k} - \bar{y}_{\cdots}) + (\bar{y}_{\cdot jk} - \bar{y}_{\cdot j\cdot} - \bar{y}_{\cdot\cdot k} + \bar{y}_{\cdots}) + (y_{ijk} - \bar{y}_{ij\cdot} - \bar{y}_{\cdot jk} + \bar{y}_{\cdot j\cdot}), \end{aligned}$$

$$SS_T = \underbrace{SS_{\text{Block}} + SS_A + SS_{E(w)}}_{\text{whole plot}} + \underbrace{SS_B + SS_{AB} + SS_{E(s)}}_{\text{subplot}},$$

$$rab - 1 = (r-1) + (a-1) + (r-1)(a-1) + (b-1) + (a-1)(b-1) + a(r-1)(b-1).$$

(Check: $(r-1) + (a-1) + (r-1)(a-1) = ra - 1$ and $(b-1)[1 + (a-1) + a(r-1)] = (b-1)ar$; sum $= rab - 1$.)

Term	R i	F j	F k	R l	EMS
τ_i	1	a	b	1	$\sigma^2 + ab\sigma^2_\tau$
β_j	r	0	b	1	$\sigma^2 + b\sigma^2_{\tau\beta} + rb\sum\beta_j^2/(a-1)$
$(\tau\beta)_{ij}$	1	0	b	1	$\sigma^2 + b\sigma^2_{\tau\beta}$
γ_k	r	a	0	1	$\sigma^2 + ra\sum\gamma_k^2/(b-1)$
$(\beta\gamma)_{jk}$	r	0	0	1	$\sigma^2 + r\sum\sum(\beta\gamma)^2_{jk}/[(a-1)(b-1)]$
$\varepsilon_{(ijk)}$	1	1	1	1	σ^2

Tests: A: $MS_A/MS_{E(w)}$; B: $MS_B/MS_{E(s)}$; AB: $MS_{AB}/MS_{E(s)}$.

Remark

Whole-plot comparisons are made against the (usually larger) whole-plot error with few df, so the whole-plot factor is estimated less precisely; the subplot factor and the interaction are estimated more precisely. Put the factor of greatest interest in the subplots when possible.

Example: Paper data, model II, line by line

$y_{\cdots} = 1297$, $\sum y^2 = 47551$, $y_{\cdots}^2/36 = 46728.03$, $SS_T = 822.97$. Block totals $417, 423, 457$; pulp totals $428, 462, 407$; temperature totals $281, 311, 341, 364$; block×pulp totals $\begin{smallmatrix} 138 & 155 & 124 \\ 141 & 149 & 133 \\ 149 & 158 & 150 \end{smallmatrix}$.

$$SS_{\text{Block}} = \frac{417^2 + 423^2 + 457^2}{12} - 46728.03 = 77.56,$$

$$SS_A = \frac{428^2 + 462^2 + 407^2}{12} - 46728.03 = 128.39,$$

$$SS_{E(w)} = \frac{\sum\sum y_{ij\cdot}^2}{4} - 46728.03 - 77.56 - 128.39 = 36.28,$$

$$SS_B = \frac{281^2 + 311^2 + 341^2 + 364^2}{9} - 46728.03 = 434.08,$$

$$SS_{AB} = \frac{\sum_j \sum_k y_{\cdot jk}^2}{3} - 46728.03 - 128.39 - 434.08 = 75.17,$$

$$SS_{E(s)} = 822.97 - 77.56 - 128.39 - 36.28 - 434.08 - 75.17 = 71.50.$$

Stratum	Source	SS	DF	MS	F_0
Whole plot	Blocks	77.56	2	38.78	
	Pulp (A)	128.39	2	64.19	$64.19/9.07 = 7.08$
	Whole-plot error	36.28	4	9.07	
Subplot	Temperature (B)	434.08	3	144.69	$144.69/3.97 = 36.43$
	A×B	75.17	6	12.53	$12.53/3.97 = 3.15$
	Subplot error	71.50	18	3.97	
	Total	822.97	35		

Pulp: $P = 0.049$; temperature: $P < 10^{-7}$; interaction: $P = 0.027$ (same as `aov(y~pulp*temp+Error(block/pulp))`). Under model I the 18 subplot-error df would split into block×temp ($SS = 20.67$, 6 df) and block×pulp×temp (12 df).

Example: Paint dispersion (Final 2025)

Four pigment mixes (A, fixed), three application methods (B, fixed: brushing, spraying, rolling), three days (blocks, random). A mix is prepared once per day and applied by all three methods: mix is the whole-plot factor, method is the subplot factor. $y_{ijk} = \mu + \tau_i + \beta_j + (\tau\beta)_{ij} + \gamma_k + (\beta\gamma)_{jk} + \varepsilon_{ijk}$ (i: day, j: mix, k: method).

Source	DF	F_0
Days (blocks)	2	–
Mix (A)	3	$MS_A/MS_{E(w)}$
Whole-plot error (days×mix)	6	
Method (B)	2	$MS_B/MS_{E(s)}$
Mix×Method	6	$MS_{AB}/MS_{E(s)}$
Subplot error	$a(r-1)(b-1) = 4 \cdot 2 \cdot 2 = 16$	
Total	35	

Example: R degrees of freedom (Final 2025, lab)

Two replicates (blocks), A with 4 levels (whole plot), B with 3 levels (subplot): `summary(aov(obs~A*B+Error(block/A)))`. Error: block — residual df $r-1=1$; Error: block:A — A df 3, residual df $(r-1)(a-1)=3$; Error: Within — B df 2, A:B df 6, residual df $a(r-1)(b-1) = 4 \cdot 1 \cdot 2 = 8$. Total $= 1+3+3+2+6+8 = 23 = 24-1$.

Other examples of split-plot structure: (i) TV-tube screen colour difference: on each of 5 days (whole plots, with 3 replicates), 4 operators measure in random order — day is the whole-plot factor, operator the subplot factor; (ii) the paint dispersion study above.